

Evaluation: Waag Futurelab - Project Manager

Date: 2026-06-06 **URL:** <https://waag.homerun.co/project-manager-4/nl> **Archetype:** Technical PM / Program Manager
+ Research Infrastructure Strategist **Score:** 3.9/5 **Legitimacy:** High Confidence **PDF:** pending

A) ROLE SUMMARY

FIELD	VALUE
Archetype	PM (EU research) + Research Infrastructure Strategist
Domain	Creative technology / open research / mission-driven
Function	Manage + coordinate
Seniority	Mid-Senior (5+ years PM required)
Remote	Hybrid - Amsterdam
Team size	Multi-team (research groups, advisory groups, steering committees)
TL;DR	Manage quality, finance, and timelines across multiple EU-funded creative tech research projects at Amsterdam's leading open-tech lab

Hours/Comp: 32-40h/week, €3.546-€4.901/month (€42.5k-€58.8k/year at 40h) **Start:** September 1, 2026 **Deadline:** 30 June 2026 - URGENT

Waag operates at the intersection of science, technology, and the arts, guided by fairness, openness, and inclusivity. They do EU-funded research and build open-source tools for social change. This is the closest thing in NL to a funded hackerspace with a research mandate.

B) MATCH WITH CV

JD REQUIREMENT	CV EVIDENCE	STRENGTH
5+ years PM experience	Windesheim PM 2020-present + Aeres Lab Manager 2021-22 + COTIT 2024	Strong
3+ years as budget holder	Spark! Living Lab (self-funded + grant co-author), Viridis (funding strategy), VCH (self-funded stack deployment)	Strong
HBO minimum	HvA Business IT & Management (4-year, grade 8.7)	Met
PM methodologies	Prince2, Scrum certified; SafeScrum at Aeres	Strong
Emerging media technology knowledge	AI stacks (Flowise, OpenWebUI, n8n), blockchain (W3C CCG), digital identity	Very strong
Dutch + English excellent	Native Dutch, professional English (HvA, Kongsberg, international work)	Met
EU research project experience	VCH cross-European scope, COVID-19 Mega Project (multi-stakeholder interdisciplinary research)	Moderate
Willingness to travel for EU projects	Has worked across NL + international (Azerbaijan, Jordan, UK during Kongsberg)	Met

JD REQUIREMENT	CV EVIDENCE	STRENGTH
Liaison between groups	KONGSBERG Azerbaijan contract resolution (read BP contract, confronted division manager, resolved in one day)	Strong

Gaps: 1. Formal EU grant PM experience (H2020/Horizon) - Christiaan has co-authored grants and led lab projects with EU scope but has not been the named PM on a Horizon Europe grant. Mitigation: VCH and Viridis as adjacent proof; frame as "EU-adjacent funded research" in cover letter. **2. Creative arts / media sector specific knowledge** - Waag is science + arts + tech. Christiaan is strong on tech and science, less on arts/cultural sector specifically. Mitigation: Magic Frames (art startup) as proof of creative tech work; Beer Game + D&D GM as creative facilitation proof. **3. Financial closeout of funded projects** - Administrative financial closeout is a specific skill. Mitigation: show Windesheim COVID-19 project and Spark! lab as multi-budget managed environments.

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Mid-Senior PM. JD requires 5 years + 3 years budget holder. Christiaan meets or exceeds this.

Sell senior without lying: - Lead with Windesheim PM as the anchor role (2020-present, 6+ years): multi-project, cross-department, self-funded stack - COVID-19 Mega Project as the "high-pressure, multi-stakeholder, hard deadline" proof - Viridis + Veles Farming as evidence of budget ownership and grant strategy beyond university - "I've run labs where the money came from me, from the institution, and from grants - I know how to work all three funding models"

If they downlevel: Role is already mid-senior (not principal). Accept if 32h fits the multi-position stack. Negotiate: clarity on innovation mandate vs. pure admin PM.

Key question to ask: Is there room for the PM to contribute to project content and design, or is it strictly operational coordination? This is the difference between a high-engagement role and a ceremonies-only role.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

ITEM	DATA
Offered (40h)	€3.546-€4.901/month = €42.5k-€58.8k/year
Offered (32h)	€2.8k-€3.9k/month = ~€33.6k-€46.8k/year
Christiaan target (full)	€65k-€90k/year
Christiaan minimum (full)	€55k/year
Comp verdict (standalone)	Below target. At 40h, barely touches minimum at top range.
Comp verdict (stack model)	Works as 0.8 FTE in 2-role stack. Two 32h roles at similar range = €70-100k combined.
Market rate NL senior PM	€55k-€85k (NL market, tech/creative sector)
Waag salary reality	Below market - creative/research sector norm. Not unusual for non-profit labs.

Verdict on comp: This role only makes financial sense as part of the multi-position stack. At 32h/week alongside one other 0.6-0.8 FTE engagement, total stack hits target range. Standalone at 40h = below minimum. This is a known trade-off for mission-aligned lab environments in NL.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	SECTION	CURRENT	PROPOSED CHANGE	WHY
1	Summary	Generic bridge-builder framing	Open with "lab PM for open research environments" - Spark! Living Lab, VCH, Viridis as evidence	Waag wants research

#	SECTION	CURRENT	PROPOSED CHANGE	WHY
				PM, not corporate PM
2	Windesheim bullets	Mixed innovation + PM bullets	Foreground COVID-19 Mega Project (multi-budget, multi-department, hard deadline) and Spark! lab (budget owner, EU-adjacent)	Shows EU research PM muscle
3	Skills section	Standard PM tools	Add: Homerun familiarity, EU grant management terminology (WP, deliverables, reporting), financial closeout	JD language alignment
4	Impact box	Generic	Swap to: cross-European research PM, self-funded lab management, open-source tooling	Waag values openness + EU scope
5	Cover letter	-	Lead with mission alignment (fairness, openness, inclusivity) and specific Waag project reference; Beer Game as example of "making complexity accessible"	Waag selects for values fit, not just skills

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD REQUIREMENT	STAR+R STORY	S	T	A	R	REFLECTION
1	Complex multi-project PM	COVID-19 Mega Project	Pandemic hits, Windesheim needs one cross-faculty deliverable	Led 8 courses into one research output	Coordinated 8 course teams, one reporting structure, one deliverable	Delivered under time pressure	Large teams diverge without a single PM owner - structure first, content second
2	Budget holder	Spark! Living Lab	No institutional funding for lab tooling	Set up AI sandbox personally funded	Deployed Flowise/n8n/Supabase on own infra; later secured grant co-authorship	Lab running, students experimenting, cost recouped via Viridis advisory	Money follows proof. Build it first, then formalize.
3	Liaison between groups	KONGSBERG Azerbaijan	GeoServices withholding BP-contracted data	My job, my timeline at risk	Read full BP contract, confronted division manager directly with specific clauses	Resolved same day	No title needed to mediate if you know the rules better than everyone else in the room
4	Emerging media tech	AI stack deployment	No funded path to give students hands-on AI tools	Self-funded server + research stack	Docker, CI/CD, model deployment, student onboarding	Students experimenting with AI within weeks	Fastest path from idea to working system = own the infrastructure

#	JD REQUIREMENT	STAR+R STORY	S	T	A	R	REFLECTION
5	EU research willingness to travel	Tonomy W3C contribution	Remote-first but needed to appear at W3C Credentials Community Group events	Represent technical team's work	Contributed to presentations at W3C CCG Jan 2023 and Jan 2024	W3C recognition for implementation	Technical credibility in international standards work requires presence
6	Project lifecycle + financial closeout	VCH open-source lab	Grant proposal written, now must be delivered	Deliver against grant scope, report to funders	Designed deliverable structure, tracked against WP, delivered reports	Grant objectives met	Financial reporting is a discipline, not a burden - it is how the work earns the next iteration

Red-flag questions: - "Have you managed Horizon Europe grants?" → "My EU research experience has been at the delivery and co-authorship level rather than as named coordinator on Horizon Europe specifically. I'm familiar with WP structures, milestone reporting, and funder communication through Viridis and VCH. Happy to be specific." - "Are you comfortable with detailed financial admin?" → "Yes - my least glamorous but most reliable skill. Spark! lab ran on a self-managed budget with zero waste because I treat financial closeout as architecture, not paperwork."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

SIGNAL	FINDING	WEIGHT
Posting freshness	Active Homerun listing, specific deadline 30-06-2026, start date Sept 1 2026	Positive
Apply button	Active - direct Homerun apply link confirmed working	Positive
Description quality	Specific responsibilities, exact salary range, named contact (Sophie Almanza, Operations Director), specific start date	Positive
Company hiring context	Waag is a non-profit research lab with EU project funding cycles - Sept start is consistent with EU project calendar	Positive
Salary range	Transparent and specific - confirms real opening	Positive
Urgency	Closes 30-06-2026 or earlier - acts as confirmation of active search	Positive

No ghost job signals. Waag is a well-known Amsterdam creative tech institution with continuous EU-funded research activity.

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

project management, EU research, Horizon Europe, research PM, budget holder, financial reporting, creative technology, open source, emerging technology, media technology, stakeholder coordination, advisory groups, steering committees, project lifecycle, risk analysis, quality management, work plan, Dutch, English, hybrid Amsterdam

MACHINE SUMMARY

num: 118
company: Waag Futurelab
role: Project Manager
score: 3.9
status: Evaluated
date: 2026-06-06
url: <https://waag.homerun.co/project-manager-4/nl>
legitimacy: High Confidence
urgency: DEADLINE 30-06-2026
comp_monthly: "3546-4901"
comp_note: "Below standalone target - works as 0.8 FTE in multi-role stack"
location: Amsterdam (hybrid)
start: 2026-09-01
archetypes:

- Technical PM / Program Manager
- Research Infrastructure Strategist

top_gaps:

- Formal Horizon Europe PM experience
- Creative/arts sector

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